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The USA

The Council of Institutional Investors (CII), Corporate Governance Policies state that at least 2/3rd of the directors should be independent. The Nominating and Corporate Governance Committee is one of the three standing committees, along with Audit Committee and Compensation Committee, required by NYSE, to be composed entirely of Independent Directors. G20/ OECD principles encourage formulation of Nomination Committee to ensure proper compliance with established nomination procedures and to facilitate and co-ordinate the search for a balanced and qualified Board.

Formulation of various Committees

i. Audit Committee,
ii. Advisory Committee,
iii. Nomination and Remuneration Committee,
iv. Stakeholder Relationship Committee

The U.S. National Association of Corporate Directors (NACD), recommends that the Governance Committee should be responsible for ensuring that a process exists for the Board to routinely assess its own performance, the performance of its Committees as well as individual directors to conduct self- assessment.

Europe

European commission urges member states to have sufficient number of independent non-executive or supervisory directors on Board. G20/ OECD: The latest principles encourage the prominent role of independent Board members. It states that, it is a good practice where remuneration policy and contracts for Board members and key executives is handled by a special committee of the Board comprising either wholly or a majority of Independent Directors. Independent Directors Board to have specific proportion of Independent Directors Although, there is no specific law to enforce number of women directors on the Board, following countries have taken steps to maintain the ratio of female Board representation (source: www.cfainstitute. org): predetermined and measurable performance criteria, including criteria of a non-financial Nature. The UK Corporate Governance Code recommends evaluation of the Board of FTSE 350 companies to be externally facilitated at least every three years (on a comply-or-explain basis) The European Commission has proposed legislation that would require nonexecutive directors to be 40% women by 2020, up from 16.6% in 2013.

Japan

In early 2014, Japanese Prime Minister announced the goal of increasing the percentage of women in executive positions at Japanese companies to 30% by 2020.

The UK

UK businesses had voluntary targets first set in 2011 i.e. to have 25% women on FTSE100 (The Financial Times Stock Exchange) Boards by 2015.

Canada

At the Federal level, two bills are currently being tabled which will impose a 40% quota for female Board members of public companies and other regulated entities such as banks and insurance companies.

Brazil

A bill pending in the Brazilian Senate would impose a 40% female quota on the Boards